



# Pool & spa barriers — what the plans must show

Barriers are assessed to AS 1926.1. These are the items that decide it.

**DRAFT — NOT PUBLISHED.** Figures below are the commonly applied AS 1926.1 requirements — the registered building surveyor to verify each against the current standard and WA regulations before release.

## THE NUMBERS THAT GET CHECKED EVERY TIME

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Barrier height            | Minimum <b>1200 mm</b> , measured on the outside (approach side), anywhere along the barrier.                                                                     |
| Gap under the barrier     | No more than <b>100 mm</b> from finished ground.                                                                                                                  |
| Non-climbable zone        | A <b>900 mm</b> quadrant on the outside of the barrier clear of footholds — no horizontal rails, retaining, planters, BBQs or trees inside it.                    |
| Gates                     | Self-closing and self-latching from any position, opening <b>away</b> from the pool, latch release at least <b>1500 mm</b> above ground (or internally shielded). |
| Boundary fence as barrier | Effective height on the <i>inside</i> of at least <b>1800 mm</b> with its own non-climbable zone on the inside face. [Confirm quoted figure.]                     |
| Windows & doors           | Doors are not acceptable as part of the barrier for new pools; openable windows into the pool area are restricted. [Confirm current WA position wording.]         |

## WHAT THE SITE PLAN MUST SHOW

- ✓ The **barrier line** drawn right around the pool zone — fences, walls, gates, and which existing fences are being relied on.
- ✓ **Gate positions and swing direction.**
- ✓ **Heights** of every barrier element, including existing boundary fences being relied on.
- ✓ Anything inside the non-climbable zones — retaining, equipment, landscaping — so we can see it's clear.
- ✓ The pool/spa itself dimensioned to boundaries, with the engineering or manufacturer's specification attached.

**The common bounce:** a compliant fence with a climbable object beside it — a retaining wall, a raised planter, the filter box. Walk the barrier line on the plan and ask "could a five-year-old use this?" That's the assessment.

## AFTER THE PERMIT

Local governments inspect pool barriers on an ongoing cycle after construction — keeping the barrier compliant is a permanent obligation, not a one-off. [Insert current WA inspection interval.]